# SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

**25 May 2022 · Shift 3**

78 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 22 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

## English Language 20 questions

**Q.1**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A storm in a tea cup

**(A)** Tasty tea
**(B)** The tea in which spices are added
**(C)** A lot of anger and worry about trivial things
**(D)** To enjoy tea during a storm

**Q.2**

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. I “was look forward to helping” you complete the project.

**(A)** look forward helping
**(B)** look forward to helping
**(C)** look forwarding to helps
**(D)** look forwarding to helping

**Q.3**

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

**(A)** Leverage
**(B)** Oscilate
**(C)** Bonfire
**(D)** Ensue

**Q.5**

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech. He said, “It’s been raining since last night.”

**(A)** He said that it had rained since last night.
**(B)** He said that it had been raining since the night before.
**(C)** He’s said that it had been raining since yesterday.
**(D)** He said that it’s raining since last night.

**Q.7**

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. She bought the “fine” cloth in the store.

**(A)** more fine
**(B)** finest
**(C)** most fine
**(D)** finer

**Q.8**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Primitive

**(A)** Technical
**(B)** Racial
**(C)** Sophisticated
**(D)** Agricultural

**Q.9**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. One day, I was handed a few volumes of new literature unlike anything I had ever read before and so _____ as to make me utterly forget my hopeless state.

**(A)** repelling
**(B)** captivating
**(C)** boring
**(D)** unrealistic

**Q.10**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Tell upon

**(A)** To strike hard
**(B)** to advise someone
**(C)** To affect adversely
**(D)** To write down

**Q.12**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The study of population and its dynamics

**(A)** Democracy
**(B)** Demography
**(C)** Dysgraphia
**(D)** Dermatology

**Q.13**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The roof _____ the weight of the snow.

**(A)** collapsed under
**(B)** collapsed to
**(C)** collapsed with
**(D)** collapsed for

**Q.15**

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. 'Don Quixote' was written by Miguel Cervantes.

**(A)** Miguel Cervantes was writing 'Don Quixote'.
**(B)** Miguel Cervantes wrote 'Don Quixote'.
**(C)** Miguel Cervantes had written 'Don Quixote'.
**(D)** Miguel Cervantes has written 'Don Quixote'.

**Q.17**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. He has been / excused by the teacher / by the time a formal complaint / for bullying was made.

**(A)** excused by the teacher
**(B)** for bullying was made
**(C)** by the time a formal complaint
**(D)** He has been

**Q.18**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an INCORRECTLY spelt word. The mother's tired and overrought mind could not process / the information of the demise of her only son / and she sat like a statue even when her / tormentors passed several obnoxious comments.

**(A)** her tormentors passed several obnoxious comments
**(B)** The mother's tired and overrought mind could not process
**(C)** the information of the demise of her only son
**(D)** and she sat like a statue even when her

**Q.19**

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Manoj "was living" in the city since 1993.

**(A)** has been living
**(B)** No substitution required
**(C)** is living
**(D)** will be living

**Q.20**

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. His mother, whose name no one knows, is found on the street, and dies just after Oliver's birth. B. After the other boys bully Oliver into asking for more gruel at the end of a meal, Mr. Bumble offers five pounds to anyone who will take the boy away from the workhouse. C. Oliver Twist is born in a workhouse in 1830s England. D. Oliver spends the first nine years of his life in a badly run home for young orphans and then is transferred to a workhouse for adults.

**(A)** CBDA
**(B)** CDAB
**(C)** BDCA
**(D)** CADB

**Q.21**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the options given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In terms of education, children must receive proper care, (1)_____ and schooling. By (2)_____ child marriage, the best possible future of children can be (3)_____. When there is an economic crisis, many programmes must be held so that they can (4)_____ how to fight for themselves (5)_____ and efficiently.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1.

**(A)** guidance
**(B)** dress
**(C)** food
**(D)** help

**Q.22**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the options given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In terms of education, children must receive proper care, (1)_____ and schooling. By (2)_____ child marriage, the best possible future of children can be (3)_____. When there is an economic crisis, many programmes must be held so that they can (4)_____ how to fight for themselves (5)_____ and efficiently.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2.

**(A)** violating
**(B)** allowing
**(C)** ignoring
**(D)** outlawing

**Q.23**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the options given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In terms of education, children must receive proper care, (1)_____ and schooling. By (2)_____ child marriage, the best possible future of children can be (3)_____. When there is an economic crisis, many programmes must be held so that they can (4)_____ how to fight for themselves (5)_____ and efficiently.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3.

**(A)** envisioned
**(B)** navigated
**(C)** awaited
**(D)** scheduled

**Q.24**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the options given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In terms of education, children must receive proper care, (1)_____ and schooling. By (2)_____ child marriage, the best possible future of children can be (3)_____. When there is an economic crisis, many programmes must be held so that they can (4)_____ how to fight for themselves (5)_____ and efficiently.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4.

**(A)** Learn
**(B)** Plan
**(C)** Educate
**(D)** teach

**Q.25**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the options given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In terms of education, children must receive proper care, (1)_____ and schooling. By (2)_____ child marriage, the best possible future of children can be (3)_____. When there is an economic crisis, many programmes must be held so that they can (4)_____ how to fight for themselves (5)_____ and efficiently.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5.

**(A)** Eloquently
**(B)** effectively
**(C)** abruptly
**(D)** Affectively

## General Intelligence 19 questions

**Q.1**

In a certain code language, 'GOLD' is written as 'HPME', and 'FAKE' is written as 'GBLF'. How will 'SOAP' be written in that language?

**(A)** TPQB
**(B)** TBPQ
**(C)** PTBQ
**(D)** TPBQ

**Q.3**

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 64*4*3*71*19*5*43

**(A)** −,+,×,=,−,×
**(B)** +,=,×,÷,−,+
**(C)** ×,+,=,−,×,−
**(D)** ÷,+,=,−, ×,+

**Q.4**

Pointing to a woman in a picture, Taran said, "She is the mother of the father-in-law of my husband". How is Taran related to that woman?

**(A)** Mother
**(B)** Granddaughter
**(C)** Sister
**(D)** Daughter

**Q.5**

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs, except one. Find that odd number pair.

**(A)** 3 : 7
**(B)** 15 : 63
**(C)** 8 : 26
**(D)** 23 : 123

**Q.6**

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 4, 9, 17, 30, 50, 81, 125, ?

**(A)** 186
**(B)** 166
**(C)** 168
**(D)** 163

**Q.7**

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Cow : Bull :: Mice : ?

**(A)** Cat
**(B)** Fox
**(C)** Mouse
**(D)** Dog

**Q.9**

If A denotes '+', B denotes '×', C denotes '–' and D denotes '÷', then what will come in place of '?' in the following equation? 41 C 29 A (38 B 3) D 19 A 61 C 17 = ?

**(A)** 70
**(B)** 66
**(C)** 58
**(D)** 62

**Q.10**

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the sixth term is related to the fifth term. 25 :4 :: 64 : ? :: 225 :14

**(A)** 8
**(B)** 10
**(C)** 7
**(D)** 9

**Q.11**

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 569, 526,483,440,397,?

**(A)** 369
**(B)** 340
**(C)** 326
**(D)** 354

**Q.12**

In a certain code language, 'FLEECE' is written as 'EFCLEE' and 'OVERCOAT' is written as 'TOAVOECR'. How will 'MITTEN' be written in that language?

**(A)** NMIETT
**(B)** NMEITT
**(C)** NMETIT
**(D)** NEMITT

**Q.13**

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 31*29*43*85*5

**(A)** +,×,=,–
**(B)** +,–,=,÷
**(C)** +,+,=,×
**(D)** =,+,–,÷

**Q.14**

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? ZFOE, PYUA, FRAW, VKES, ?

**(A)** KDIO
**(B)** KCIO
**(C)** LDIO
**(D)** LCIO

**Q.15**

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs EXCEPT one. Find that odd number pair.

**(A)** 33 – 24
**(B)** 54 – 36
**(C)** 45 – 30
**(D)** 48 – 32

**Q.17**

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and fourth term related to third term. 9 : 270 :: 15 : 450 :: 13 : ?

**(A)** 390
**(B)** 385
**(C)** 380
**(D)** 395

**Q.20**

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? ERKV, HYVK, ?, NMRO, QTCD

**(A)** KFGZ
**(B)** KSEV
**(C)** FNQI
**(D)** KXGW

**Q.22**

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Vantage 2.Wherefore 3.Uplift 4.Various 5.Variety 6.Valor

**(A)** 3,6,1,5,4,2
**(B)** 3,1,6,4,5,2
**(C)** 3,6,1,4,5,2
**(D)** 6,3,1,5,4,2

**Q.23**

In a certain code language, 'COMPUTER' is written as 'RETUCOMP' and 'LAPTOP' is written as 'POTLAP'. How will 'BOTTLE' be written in that language?

**(A)** ELTBOT
**(B)** ELTBTO
**(C)** ETLBOT
**(D)** ELTTOB

**Q.24**

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 14, 14, 12, 36, 32, 160, ?

**(A)** 150
**(B)** 166
**(C)** 154
**(D)** 145

**Q.25**

Three Statements are given followed by Three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All books are copies. No copy is a pen. Some erasers are books. Conclusions: I. Some copies are erasers. II. Some pens are books. III. No eraser is a pen.

**(A)** Only conclusion II follows.
**(B)** Both conclusions I and II follow.
**(C)** Both conclusions I and III follow.
**(D)** Only conclusion I follows.

## Quantitative Aptitude 14 questions

**Q.3**

A software company has only 3 divisions that have 20, 30 and 40 employees, respectively. If the working percentage of this during a weekend were 20%, 30% and 40%, respectively, then the working percentage of the entire company during that weekend was approximately:

**(A)** 0.0032
**(B)** 3.2
**(C)** 0.032
**(D)** 32

**Q.5**

There are two types of milk. The price of one type of milk is ₹70/litre and the price of other type of milk is ₹50/litre. If the two types of milk are mixed, the price of new mixture will be ₹55/litre. Find the ratio of the two types of milk in this new mixture.

**(A)** 1 : 1
**(B)** 1 : 2
**(C)** 1 : 4
**(D)** 1 : 3

**Q.6**

A man completes a journey in ten hours.He travels at a speed of 21 km/h for the first half of the journey and at a speed of 24 km/h for the second half. Calculate the total distance travelled (in kilometres).

**(A)** 212
**(B)** 224
**(C)** 235
**(D)** 230

**Q.8**

If p = 11, then the value of $p(p^2 + 3p + 3)$ is:

**(A)** 1629
**(B)** 1225
**(C)** 1727
**(D)** 1111

**Q.9**

$24 - [52 - \{4 + 10 \times (-3)\}] = ?$

**(A)** 54
**(B)** –54
**(C)** –44
**(D)** 44

**Q.13**

In an election, the winning candidate received 15744 votes, which are 48% of the electorate. The only other candidate received 22% of the electorate. What is the number of members who did NOT vote?

**(A)** 9860
**(B)** 9870
**(C)** 9840
**(D)** 9850

**Q.15**

The price of a certain laptop is discounted by 20% and the reduced price is then discounted by 20%. This series of successive discounts is equivalent to a single discount of:

**(A)** 20%
**(B)** 26%
**(C)** 30%
**(D)** 36%

**Q.16**

A man sells goods at 4% loss on cost price but he gives 20 g instead of 40 g. What is his profit or loss percentage?

**(A)** 84% profit
**(B)** 92% profit
**(C)** 82% loss
**(D)** 92% loss

**Q.18**

Two trains each 200m long are moving in opposite directions. They cross each other in 10 seconds. If the speed of one train is 90km/h, find the speed of the other train.

**(A)** 90 km/h
**(B)** 45 km/h
**(C)** 54 km/h
**(D)** 36 km/h

**Q.19**

The distance travelled by a person varies directly with the duration of the journey. If the person travels 378 km in 7 hours, in how many hours will the person cover 918 km?

**(A)** 16
**(B)** 15
**(C)** 18
**(D)** 17

**Q.20**

A sum of ₹16,875, when invested at r% interest per year compounded annually, amounts to ₹19,683 after 2 years. What is the value of r?

**(A)** 8
**(B)** 7
**(C)** 6
**(D)** 9

**Q.22**

What is the least positive value of A in the number 34278A2597, which is divisible by 9?

**(A)** 7
**(B)** 2
**(C)** 1
**(D)** 8

**Q.24**

A shopkeeper offers 25% discount on all table lamps. He offers a further discount of 8% on the reduced price to those customers who pay cash. What does a customer have to pay in cash for a table lamp of ₹2,500?

**(A)** ₹1,725
**(B)** ₹1,865
**(C)** ₹2,220
**(D)** ₹1,780

**Q.25**

A rectangular water tank is 1.5 m high, 3 m long and 3.5 m wide. How much water (in litres) can it hold?

**(A)** 13520
**(B)** 14510
**(C)** 15750
**(D)** 11780

## General Awareness 25 questions

**Q.1**

Due to the service done by the poet _____, the Kathakali dance form received a new impetus and today, many innovations are also being made to suit the needs of a changing society.

**(A)** Purandara Dasa
**(B)** Vallathol Narayana Menon
**(C)** Satchidanandan
**(D)** Gopal Bhatta

**Q.2**

How do the red algae reproduce vegetatively?

**(A)** Fission
**(B)** Spore formation
**(C)** Cutting
**(D)** Fragmentation

**Q.3**

How many players were honoured with the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award in 2021?

**(A)** 14
**(B)** 18
**(C)** 16
**(D)** 12

**Q.4**

Which of the following is a type of large, brown seaweed that grows in shallow, nutrient-rich salt water near coastal fronts around the world?

**(A)** Alpina
**(B)** Kelp
**(C)** Seagrass
**(D)** Corals

**Q.5**

Pritam Rani Siwach who received the prestigious 2021 Dronacharya Award contributed to the field of:

**(A)** para shooting
**(B)** athletics
**(C)** hockey
**(D)** boxing

**Q.6**

Padma Shri awardee Guru Gangadhar Pradhan is an accomplished dancer of which of the following dance forms?

**(A)** Manipuri
**(B)** Kathakali
**(C)** Odissi
**(D)** Kathak

**Q.7**

Who among the following is a famous violinist?

**(A)** Sajjad Hussain
**(B)** Anoushka Shankar
**(C)** Krishna R Chaudhary
**(D)** Nagai R Muralidharan

**Q.8**

When the government resorts to borrowing only to clear the backlog if interest payments, it is referred to as _____.

**(A)** zero revenue deficit
**(B)** zero primary deficit
**(C)** zero fiscal deficit
**(D)** excess budget deficit

**Q.9**

The term 'header' is associated to which of the following sports?

**(A)** Football
**(B)** Cricket
**(C)** Hockey
**(D)** Basketball

**Q.10**

Identify the wrong pair with respect to different motions and their examples.

**(A)** Periodic motion - Earth rotating on its axis
**(B)** Rectilinear motion - A stone thrown up in the air at an angle
**(C)** Rotational motion - Blades of a windmill
**(D)** Oscillatory motion - A boat tossing up and down a river

**Q.11**

'The Great Indian Novel', a satirical novel that recreates the Hindu epic Mahabharata within the context of the Indian National Movement, is written by which of the following writers who is a member of the Indian Parliament?

**(A)** Shashi Tharoor
**(B)** Arun Shourie
**(C)** Abhijeet Banerjee
**(D)** Amiya Kumar Bagchi

**Q.12**

Identify the group of the periodic table to which cobalt belongs.

**(A)** Group 6
**(B)** Group 9
**(C)** Group 5
**(D)** Group 7

**Q.13**

Which of the following mountains is formed as a result of the compression of tectonic plates, leading to the formation of large fold-like structures on the Earth's crust?

**(A)** Ural mountain in Russia
**(B)** Vosges mountain in Europe
**(C)** Mt.Kilimanjaro in Africa
**(D)** Harz mountains in Germany

**Q.14**

B Herambanathan who was awarded with the 'Sangeet Natak Akademi Award' in 2013 is a _____ dancer.

**(A)** Odissi
**(B)** Kuchipudi
**(C)** Bharatanatyam
**(D)** Kathak

**Q.15**

Which Article of the Indian Constitution states that "Supreme Court to be a court of record"?

**(A)** Article 135
**(B)** Article 126
**(C)** Article 129
**(D)** Article 131

**Q.16**
Hariprasad Chaurasia is associated with which of the following instruments?

**(A)** Shehnai
**(B)** Bansuri
**(C)** Sarod
**(D)** Tabla

**Q.17**
In July 2021, Kiren Rijiju was made the Cabinet Minister and given the charge of which of the following ministries?

**(A)** Ministry of Communication and Electronics and Information Technology
**(B)** Ministry of Civil Aviation
**(C)** Ministry of Ports and Shipping
**(D)** Ministry of Law and Justice

**Q.18**
How is tuberculosis spread in humans?

**(A)** Inoculation into skin
**(B)** Droplet infection
**(C)** Direct touching
**(D)** Contact with soil

**Q.19**
'Moon Walk' is an autobiography of ___.

**(A)** Oscar Wilde
**(B)** Marlon Brando
**(C)** Michael Jackson
**(D)** Anne Frank

**Q.20**
Who among the following personalities is associated with the Mohiniattam dance?

**(A)** Yamini Krishnamurthy
**(B)** Jayaprabha Menon
**(C)** Prerana Shrimali
**(D)** Vyjayanthi Kashi

**Q.21**
What is the name of the autobiography written by Mr Abhinav Bindra, the Olympic medallist from India?

**(A)** An Autobiography
**(B)** A shot at History
**(C)** Courage and Conviction
**(D)** All from Memory

**Q.22**
WINTER Olympics 2026 will be hosted by which of the following countries?

**(A)** Spain
**(B)** Brazil
**(C)** The US
**(D)** Italy

**Q.23**
In which year did Hindustani Classical vocalist Rashid Khan receive the Padma Bhushan award?

**(A)** 2019
**(B)** 2020
**(C)** 2021
**(D)** 2022

**Q.24**
Who among the following founded Odissi dance school 'SRJAN' in 1993?

**(A)** Kumkum Mohanty
**(B)** Ratikant Mohapatra
**(C)** Madhavi Mudgal
**(D)** Kelucharan Mohapatra

**Q.25**
The Ganga plain extend between which two rivers?

**(A)** Yamuna and Teesta
**(B)** Ghaggar and Teesta
**(C)** Ghaggar and Bhagirathi
**(D)** Ganga and Teesta

## Answer key

### English Language

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(C)** | Q.2 **(B)** | Q.3 **(B)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.7 **(B)** | Q.8 **(C)** |
| Q.9 **(B)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.12 **(B)** | Q.13 **(A)** | Q.15 **(B)** | Q.17 **(D)** |
| Q.18 **(B)** | Q.19 **(A)** | Q.20 **(D)** | Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(D)** | Q.23 **(A)** |
| Q.24 **(A)** | Q.25 **(B)** | | | | |

### General Intelligence

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(D)** | Q.3 **(D)** | Q.4 **(B)** | Q.5 **(D)** | Q.6 **(A)** | Q.7 **(C)** |
| Q.9 **(D)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.11 **(D)** | Q.12 **(B)** | Q.13 **(B)** | Q.14 **(C)** |
| Q.15 **(A)** | Q.17 **(A)** | Q.20 **(A)** | Q.22 **(A)** | Q.23 **(A)** | Q.24 **(C)** |
| Q.25 **(D)** | | | | | |

### Quantitative Aptitude

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.3 **(D)** | Q.5 **(D)** | Q.6 **(B)** | Q.8 **(C)** | Q.9 **(B)** | Q.13 **(C)** |
| Q.15 **(D)** | Q.16 **(B)** | Q.18 **(C)** | Q.19 **(D)** | Q.20 **(A)** | Q.22 **(A)** |
| Q.24 **(A)** | Q.25 **(C)** | | | | |

### General Awareness

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(B)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.3 **(D)** | Q.4 **(B)** | Q.5 **(C)** | Q.6 **(C)** |
| Q.7 **(D)** | Q.8 **(B)** | Q.9 **(A)** | Q.10 **(B)** | Q.11 **(A)** | Q.12 **(B)** |
| Q.13 **(A)** | Q.14 **(C)** | Q.15 **(C)** | Q.16 **(B)** | Q.17 **(D)** | Q.18 **(B)** |
| Q.19 **(C)** | Q.20 **(B)** | Q.21 **(B)** | Q.22 **(D)** | Q.23 **(D)** | Q.24 **(D)** |
| Q.25 **(B)** | | | | | |

## Explanations

### English Language

**Q.1 · Answer (C) A lot of anger and worry about trivial things**

A 'storm in a teacup' is a great deal of anger or worry about something unimportant.

**Q.2 · Answer (B) look forward to helping**

'Look forward to' is followed by the -ing form, and 'was look' is not a verb form: 'I look forward to helping you complete the project.'

**Q.3 · Answer (B) Oscilate**

The correct spelling is 'oscillate'.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) He said that it had been raining since the night before.**

After 'said' the present perfect continuous moves back to the past perfect continuous, 'had been raining', and 'last night' becomes 'the night before'.

**Q.7 · Answer (B) finest**

'In the store' compares the cloth with all the others there, which needs the superlative: 'She bought the finest cloth in the store.'

**Q.8 · Answer (C) Sophisticated**

'Primitive' means simple or undeveloped; its opposite is 'sophisticated'.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) captivating**

Books that made the writer utterly forget a hopeless state held the attention completely: they were 'captivating'.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) To affect adversely**

To 'tell upon' something is to have a bad effect on it, as overwork tells upon health.

**Q.12 · Answer (B) Demography**

Demography is the study of populations: their size, make-up and how they change.

**Q.13 · Answer (A) collapsed under**

Something gives way 'under' a weight: 'The roof collapsed under the weight of the snow.'

**Q.15 · Answer (B) Miguel Cervantes wrote ‘Don Quixote’.**

The simple past passive 'was written by' becomes the simple past active 'wrote', with Cervantes as the subject.

**Q.17 · Answer (D) He has been**

The excusing was over 'by the time' the complaint was made, so it needs the past perfect: 'He had been excused'.

**Q.18 · Answer (B) The mother’s tired and overrought mind could not process**

The correct spelling is 'overwrought', meaning in a state of nervous agitation.

**Q.19 · Answer (A) has been living**

'Since 1993' marks an action that began in the past and is still going on, which takes the present perfect continuous: 'has been living'.

**Q.20 · Answer (D) CADB**

C introduces Oliver's birth, A tells of his mother's death just after it, D covers his first nine years and B what happened at the workhouse: CADB.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) guidance**

In terms of education, children need proper care, 'guidance' and schooling; food and dress have nothing to do with education.

**Q.22 · Answer (D) outlawing**
Child marriage harms a child's future, so it is by 'outlawing' it, making it illegal, that a better future is secured.

**Q.23 · Answer (A) envisioned**
The best possible future of children can be 'envisioned', that is imagined and planned for.

**Q.24 · Answer (A) Learn**
The programmes are for the children themselves, so that they 'learn' how to fight for themselves; 'teach' and 'educate' would make them the instructors.

**Q.25 · Answer (B) effectively**
'Effectively and efficiently' is the natural pair of adverbs; 'affectively' (to do with feelings) only sounds similar.

## General Intelligence

**Q.1 · Answer (D) TPBQ**
Each letter moves one place forward: GOLD → HPME and FAKE → GBLF. So SOAP → TPBQ.

**Q.3 · Answer (D) ÷,+,=,−, ×,+**
64 ÷ 4 + 3 = 71 − 19 × 5 + 43: the left side is 16 + 3 = 19 and the right side 71 − 95 + 43 = 19.

**Q.4 · Answer (B) Granddaughter**
The father-in-law of Taran's husband is Taran's father, and his mother is Taran's grandmother. So Taran is her granddaughter.

**Q.5 · Answer (D) 23 : 123**
In 3 : 7, 15 : 63 and 8 : 26 the first number is $n^2 - 1$ and the second $n^3 - 1$ (n = 2, 4 and 3). 23 is not one less than a square, nor 123 one less than a cube, so 23 : 123 is the odd one.

**Q.6 · Answer (A) 186**
The differences 5, 8, 13, 20, 31, 44 grow by 3, 5, 7, 11, 13, the prime numbers. The next prime is 17, so the next difference is 44 + 17 = 61: 125 + 61 = 186.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) Mouse**
SSC's key gives 'Mouse': a cow and a bull are the female and male of one animal, and of the options only 'mouse' names the same animal as 'mice'. The match is loose, as mice and mouse differ in number, not sex.

**Q.9 · Answer (D) 62**
After replacing the letters: 41 − 29 + (38 × 3) ÷ 19 + 61 − 17 = 41 − 29 + 6 + 61 − 17 = 62.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) 7**
The second number is one less than the square root of the first: $\sqrt{25} - 1 = 4$ and $\sqrt{225} - 1 = 14$. Likewise $\sqrt{64} - 1 = 7$.

**Q.11 · Answer (D) 354**
Each term is 43 less than the one before: 397 − 43 = 354.

**Q.12 · Answer (B) NMEITT**
The letters are taken last, first, second last, second and so on: FLEECE (6, 1, 5, 2, 4, 3) → EFCLEE and OVERCOAT → TOAVOECR. So MITTEN → N M E I T T: NMEITT.

**Q.13 · Answer (B) +,−,=,÷**
31 + 29 − 43 = 85 ÷ 5: both sides equal 17.

**Q.14 · Answer (C) LDIO**
First letters move back 10 (Z, P, F, V, so next L); second letters back 7 (F, Y, R, K, so D); third letters run through the vowels (O, U, A, E, so I); fourth letters move back 4 (E, A, W, S, so O): LDIO.

**Q.15 · Answer (A) 33 – 24**
In 54 – 36, 45 – 30 and 48 – 32 the second number is two-thirds of the first. Two-thirds of 33 is 22, not 24, so 33 – 24 is the odd one.

**Q.17 · Answer (A) 390**
The second number is 30 times the first: 9 × 30 = 270 and 15 × 30 = 450. Likewise 13 × 30 = 390.

**Q.20 · Answer (A) KFGZ**
First letters move +3 (E, H, K, N, Q), second letters +7 (R, Y, F, M, T), third letters +11 (K, V, G, R, C) and fourth letters −11 (V, K, Z, O, D), wrapping round the alphabet. The missing cluster is KFGZ.

**Q.22 · Answer (A) 3,6,1,5,4,2**
Uplift comes first; then Valor and Vantage ('val' before 'van'), Variety and Various ('varie' before 'vario'); Wherefore comes last: 3, 6, 1, 5, 4, 2.

**Q.23 · Answer (A) ELTBOT**
The word is split in half and the second half, reversed, is written before the first: COMP|UTER → RETU + COMP and LAP|TOP → POT + LAP. So BOT|TLE → ELT + BOT: ELTBOT.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) 154**
The steps alternate between multiplying and subtracting: ×1, −2, ×3, −4, ×5, so next −6: 160 − 6 = 154.

**Q.25 · Answer (D) Only conclusion I follows.**
Some erasers are books and all books are copies, so some copies are erasers (I follows). No copy is a pen, so no book is a pen (II does not follow). Erasers that are not books may or may not be pens, so III does not follow.

### Quantitative Aptitude

**Q.3 · Answer (D) 32**
20% of 20 + 30% of 30 + 40% of 40 = 4 + 9 + 16 = 29 of the 90 employees worked: 29/90 × 100 ≈ 32%.

**Q.5 · Answer (D) 1 : 3**
By alligation, the ₹70 milk and the ₹50 milk are in the ratio (55 − 50) : (70 − 55) = 5 : 15 = 1 : 3.

**Q.6 · Answer (B) 224**
If each half is d km, d/21 + d/24 = 10, so d × 15/168 = 10 and d = 112. The whole journey is 224 km.

**Q.8 · Answer (C) 1727**
$p(p^2 + 3p + 3) = p^3 + 3p^2 + 3p = (p + 1)^3 - 1 = 12^3 - 1 = 1727$.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) −54**
Innermost first: 4 + 10 × (−3) = −26, 52 − (−26) = 78, and 24 − 78 = −54.

**Q.13 · Answer (C) 9840**
15744 is 48% of the electorate, so 1% is 328. The two candidates together got 48% + 22% = 70%, so 30% did not vote: 30 × 328 = 9840.

**Q.15 · Answer (D) 36%**
After two 20% discounts 0.8 × 0.8 = 0.64 of the price is left: a single discount of 36%.

**Q.16 · Answer (B) 92% profit**
Taking the cost as 1 a gram, he gives 20 g (cost 20) but charges for 40 g at a 4% loss: 0.96 × 40 = 38.4. Profit = 18.4/20 × 100 = 92%.

**Q.18 · Answer (C) 54 km/h**
In opposite directions the trains cover 200 + 200 = 400 m in 10 s, so their relative speed is 40 m/s = 144 km/h. The other train runs at 144 − 90 = 54 km/h.

**Q.19 · Answer (D) 17**
The speed is 378/7 = 54 km/h, so 918 km takes 918/54 = 17 hours.

**Q.20 · Answer (A) 8**
19,683/16,875 = 729/625 = $(27/25)^2$, so 1 + r/100 = 27/25 = 1.08 and r = 8.

**Q.22 · Answer (A) 7**
A number is divisible by 9 when its digit sum is. The digits add up to 47 + A, and the least multiple of 9 it can reach is 54, so A = 7.

**Q.24 · Answer (A) ₹1,725**
₹2,500 × 0.75 × 0.92 = ₹1,725.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) 15750**
1.5 × 3 × 3.5 = 15.75 m³, and 1 m³ holds 1,000 litres: 15,750 litres.

### General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (B) Vallathol Narayana Menon**
The poet Vallathol Narayana Menon founded the Kerala Kalamandalam in 1930, which revived Kathakali.

**Q.2 · Answer (D) Fragmentation**
Red algae usually reproduce vegetatively by fragmentation: a broken piece of the thallus grows into a new plant.

**Q.3 · Answer (D) 12**
Twelve sportspersons, among them Neeraj Chopra, Mithali Raj and Sunil Chhetri, received the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna for 2021.

**Q.4 · Answer (B) Kelp**
Kelps are large brown algae that form underwater forests in shallow, nutrient-rich coastal seas.

**Q.5 · Answer (C) hockey**
Pritam Rani Siwach, a former captain of India's women's hockey team, received the Dronacharya Award in 2021 as a hockey coach.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) Odissi**
Guru Gangadhar Pradhan was an Odissi dancer and teacher who founded the Konark Natya Mandap and the Konark Dance Festival.

**Q.7 · Answer (D) Nagai R Muralidharan**
Nagai R. Muralidharan is a Carnatic violinist. Anoushka Shankar plays the sitar, and Sajjad Hussain was known for the mandolin.

**Q.8 · Answer (B) zero primary deficit**
Primary deficit is the fiscal deficit minus interest payments. If the government borrows only to pay interest, the two are equal and the primary deficit is zero.

**Q.9 · Answer (A) Football**
A header is a shot or pass in football made by striking the ball with the head.

**Q.10 · Answer (B) Rectilinear motion - A stone thrown up in the air at an angle**
A stone thrown at an angle follows a curved path, so its motion is curvilinear, not rectilinear (along a straight line). The other pairs are correctly matched.

**Q.11 · Answer (A) Shashi Tharoor**
Shashi Tharoor's 'The Great Indian Novel' (1989) retells the Mahabharata as the story of the freedom movement.

**Q.12 · Answer (B) Group 9**
Cobalt (Co) is in Group 9 of the periodic table, with rhodium and iridium.

**Q.13 · Answer (A) Ural mountain in Russia**
The Urals are old fold mountains, raised when colliding plates compressed the crust. The Vosges and the Harz are block mountains, and Kilimanjaro is a volcano.

**Q.14 · Answer (C) Bharatanatyam**
B. Herambanathan, a teacher of the Thanjavur tradition, received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for 2013 for Bharatanatyam.

**Q.15 · Answer (C) Article 129**
Article 129 makes the Supreme Court a court of record, with the power to punish for contempt of itself.

**Q.16 · Answer (B) Bansuri**
Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is a master of the bansuri, the bamboo flute.

**Q.17 · Answer (D) Ministry of Law and Justice**
In the July 2021 reshuffle Kiren Rijiju became Cabinet Minister of Law and Justice, succeeding Ravi Shankar Prasad.

**Q.18 · Answer (B) Droplet infection**
Tuberculosis spreads through the air in droplets released when an infected person coughs or sneezes.

**Q.19 · Answer (C) Michael Jackson**
'Moonwalk' (1988) is Michael Jackson's autobiography.

**Q.20 · Answer (B) Jayaprabha Menon**
Jayaprabha Menon is a Delhi-based Mohiniyattam dancer. Yamini Krishnamurthy is known for Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi, Prerana Shrimali for Kathak and Vyjayanthi Kashi for Kuchipudi.

**Q.21 · Answer (B) A shot at History**
Abhinav Bindra, the 2008 Olympic gold medallist in shooting, wrote 'A Shot at History' with Rohit Brijnath.

**Q.22 · Answer (D) Italy**
Italy hosted the 2026 Winter Olympics, at Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo.

**Q.23 · Answer (D) 2022**
Ustad Rashid Khan of the Rampur-Sahaswan gharana received the Padma Bhushan in 2022.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) Kelucharan Mohapatra**
Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra founded Srjan in Bhubaneswar in 1993; his son Ratikant Mohapatra now runs it.

**Q.25 · Answer (B) Ghaggar and Teesta**
NCERT describes the Ganga plain as extending between the Ghaggar and the Teesta.

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